

TSANGAI BUSINESS GROWTH SERIES · #16

The Business Dashboard

The seven numbers that actually run your business — on one page, updated in 15 minutes a week, explained to you by AI.

WHO IT'S FOR

Owners who steer by bank balance and gut feel, and know it

TIME REQUIRED

15 min to set up · 15 min/week to run

WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Your 7-number dashboard built and filled in with last week's data — today

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

You can't steer a business you only look at once a quarter.

Seven numbers, one page, every Monday. That's enough to spot problems weeks early and know exactly where next month's revenue is coming from. AI reads the trends so you don't need a finance degree.

Ask an owner "how's business?" and you'll hear "busy." Busy isn't a number. When I get a client onto seven weekly numbers, the same thing always happens within a month: they spot something early — a lead slowdown, a collection gap, a margin slip — that used to ambush them a quarter later. The dashboard isn't paperwork. It's headlights.

— Ray, TsangAI Consulting

WHY THIS MATTERS

7

Numbers that tell you 90% of what's happening — more just adds noise

15 min

Weekly time cost once the sheet exists — less than one coffee run

Weeks early

How much sooner weekly numbers surface problems vs. quarterly panic

THE ONE IDEA

Watch the inputs, not just the bank account.

Your bank balance tells you what already happened. Leads, quotes, and win rate tell you what's ABOUT to happen. Track both ends and you stop being surprised by your own business.

Example: A painting contractor's bank balance looked great in June — best month ever. But his dashboard showed new leads had halved. He turned marketing back on in June instead of discovering the problem in an empty August. That one catch paid for years of 15-minute Mondays.

YOUR 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

- ☐ Copy the 7-number worksheet from page 4 into a spreadsheet (or print it)
- ☐ Fill in last week's numbers — estimates are fine for week one
- ☐ Circle the one number that surprised you most
- ☐ Book a recurring 15-minute "numbers" slot every Monday morning

Five steps to a business with headlights

1 Build the one-page sheet

A simple spreadsheet: seven rows (the numbers), one column per week. No software to buy, nothing to integrate on day one.

Do this: Copy the page 4 worksheet into Google Sheets. Name it "[Business] Dashboard."

2 Fill in the first week

Pull what's easy (bank, invoices), estimate what's not (hours). Week one is about starting the habit, not audit-grade accuracy.

Do this: Enter last week's seven numbers right now, even roughly.

3 Set a target for each number

What does "good" look like weekly? Ten leads? 40% win rate? Under \$5k owed to you? Targets turn a list of numbers into a scoreboard you can win.

Do this: Add a target column. Gut-feel targets are fine — you'll tune them monthly.

4 Run the Monday ritual

Same 15 minutes every week: fill the column, compare to target, ask "what's the ONE number to move this week — and what's the one action that moves it?"

Do this: Write that one action at the bottom of the column. That's your week's focus.

5 Let AI read the trends

Once you have 4+ weeks of data, paste the sheet into AI monthly. It spots drifts and correlations you're too close to see — like win rate sliding every time response speed slips.

Do this: Run the Analyst Prompt on page 4 at month's end. Act on its #1 flag.

COMMON MISTAKES

This is where most business owners get stuck.

They track twenty numbers, drown, and quit — seven is the ceiling, not the floor. They skip "boring" weeks, and the gaps kill the trend line. And they collect numbers without ever picking the one weekly action — a dashboard you don't act on is just prettier anxiety.

PRO TIP

Share the dashboard with your team every Monday — even just a screenshot. When everyone sees the same scoreboard, you stop being the only person in the company who cares whether the business is winning. People play differently when they can see the score.

The seven numbers + the analyst prompt

The Weekly Dashboard one column per week

#	NUMBER	WHY IT MATTERS	TARGET	THIS WK
1	New leads	Fuel gauge — predicts revenue 4–8 weeks out	—	—
2	Quotes sent	Is opportunity turning into offers, fast?	—	—
3	Win rate %	Jobs won ÷ quotes sent — pricing & follow-up health	—	—
4	Revenue booked	What was actually sold this week	—	—
5	Cash collected	Booked isn't banked — this is what pays payroll	—	—
6	Owed to you (A/R)	Money stuck in other people's pockets	—	—
7	Your hours worked	The number this whole series exists to shrink	—	—

This week's ONE action to move ONE number: _____

The Analyst Prompt (monthly)

You are a plain-spoken business analyst for small service businesses. My business: **[WHAT YOU DO]**. Here are my weekly dashboard numbers for the last **[N]** weeks: **[PASTE THE TABLE]**. Tell me: 1) the three clearest trends, in plain words, 2) the one number most likely to cause a problem in 60 days, 3) the single highest-leverage action for next month, 4) one question I should be asking that these numbers can't answer. No jargon.

Make it automatic (later)

- ✓ Leads & quotes: auto-counted by your CRM (guide #05)
- ✓ Cash & A/R: pulled from your invoicing tool's report
- ✓ An automation (guide #11) can fill the sheet weekly
- ✓ Goal: Monday ritual becomes pure thinking, zero collecting

START MANUAL ANYWAY

Type the numbers by hand for the first month even if you could automate them. Touching the numbers is how they start living in your head — automation comes after understanding.

Turn this guide into one win this week.

A guide you read changes nothing. A page you fill in does. Two minutes — do it while it's fresh.

1 • WHERE I AM TODAY

All 7 numbers filled in? ☐ The number that surprised me: _____

2 • THE ONE THING I'M FIXING THIS WEEK

My one fix: _____

The first small step (under 15 minutes): _____

Small beats big. Pick something you can finish in one sitting.

3 • WHEN I'M DOING IT

Day: _____ Time: _____ Booked in my calendar? ☐

Open your calendar and book it now — a plan without a time slot is a wish.

4 • AFTER — WHAT HAPPENED

My result (hours saved, jobs booked, thing shipped): _____

What I'll do differently next time: _____

NOTES

KEEP THE STREAK

One fix a week is 52 upgrades a year. When this page is full, re-take the guide — a rising score is proof your systems are working.